

REDUNDANCY POLICY

1. Overview

This Redundancy Policy applies when the Company needs to reduce headcount due to business restructuring, economic downturn, technological changes, or closure of a business unit. The Company is committed to handling redundancies fairly, transparently, and in compliance with UK employment law.

Redundancy is always a last resort. Before commencing a redundancy process, the Company will explore alternatives including redeployment, voluntary redundancy, reduced working hours, and natural attrition.

2. Selection Criteria

Where redundancy is unavoidable, selection will be based on objective, measurable criteria. These may include: skills and qualifications, performance ratings over the past 2 years, attendance records (excluding disability-related and statutory leave), length of service, and disciplinary record.

The selection criteria will be shared with affected employees and their representatives before the consultation process begins. No selection criterion will directly or indirectly discriminate against any protected characteristic.

3. Consultation Process

Individual consultation meetings will be held with each affected employee. Employees have the right to be accompanied by a colleague or trade union representative at all consultation meetings.

For collective redundancies affecting 20 or more employees within a 90-day period, the Company will begin consultation at least 30 days before the first dismissal. For 100 or more employees, consultation begins at least 45 days before.

During consultation, the Company will discuss: the reasons for redundancy, the number and categories of affected employees, proposed selection criteria, and any measures to mitigate redundancies.

4. Redundancy Pay

Employees with at least 2 years of continuous service are entitled to statutory redundancy pay. The Company offers an enhanced redundancy package as follows:

For each completed year of service: 2 weeks' gross pay (compared to the statutory 0.5-1.5 weeks). The maximum service counted is 20 years. Redundancy pay is calculated based on the Employee's actual weekly pay, not the statutory cap.

In addition, employees made redundant will receive: payment in lieu of notice (if applicable), payment for any accrued but untaken annual leave, and an ex-gratia payment of £500 to assist with

job search costs.

5. Career Transition Support

The Company will provide career transition support to all employees affected by redundancy, including: access to outplacement services for 3 months, up to 5 days of paid time off for job interviews and training during the notice period, CV writing and interview coaching workshops, and access to the Company's internal job board for 6 months after termination.

Employees may also access the Employee Assistance Programme (EAP) for confidential counselling and support during and after the redundancy process. The EAP is available 24/7 on 0800-XXX-XXXX.

6. Appeals

Employees who believe they have been unfairly selected for redundancy may appeal in writing to the HR Director within 5 working days of receiving their redundancy notice.

An appeal hearing will be conducted by a senior manager not involved in the original selection process. The outcome will be communicated in writing within 10 working days. The decision of the appeal panel is final.